

WHAT'S IN A NAME?

Twitter user-names are lucrative words – if you signed up early you probably got your real name or a simple word. New users are not so lucky. Case in point - Twitter user @n whose account was hacked after he refused to sell his username for \$50,000.
<http://dgit.in/wvtwttr>

ANDROID BLOATWARE - A THING OF THE PAST?

Anyone who's ever used an Android phone is familiar with the bloatware that comes pre-installed that offer little or no value. But now a South Korean court has mandated that it should be possible to delete any such bloatware.
<http://dgit.in/wvbloat>

GOOGLE RANKING ISPS BASED ON YOUTUBE

The days of cursing your ISP over choppy YouTube videos may soon be over. In a move that'll force ISP to pull up their socks, Google has decided to rank them based on their ability to consistently deliver HD videos to customers. ISPs that pass the test will be YouTube HD-Certified.
<http://dgit.in/wvISP>

PRINTING A CAR? SURE!

3D printing seems to be pushing the boundaries of science, allowing us to "print" virtually anything, including food products, guns and even prosthetic limbs. Adding to this list is Honda, who will release 3D printing data for its Acura concept car.
<http://dgit.in/wvHonda>

SHORTS

The best WhatsApp alternatives for your smartphone

Now that Facebook might be in control of your data, perhaps it's time to look for some alternatives for your messaging needs

Despite the fact that WhatsApp has more than 450 million users globally and the 19 billion buyout by Facebook, not everyone we know loves the Instant Messenger client. Some cannot be bothered to be "connected" with everyone who is in their mobile phonebook while others do not like the fact that WhatsApp isn't really very private, because just about anyone can send them a message unless specifically blocked. Add to this the fact that Facebook, a company that's not had a clean record when it comes to user's privacy, now own it, its best to err on the side of caution and jump ship. The app does lack a bit of sophistication as well, when compared to some of the rivals that sport better UIs and slicker deployment of features. And, all these faults could be forgiven except for the fact that it isn't free once you finish the complementary usage period.

So, what is the alternative? Well, there are many, actually. We handpick three of the best ones for you to switch to. And before you send any brickbats our way for not including Facebook Messenger or Google Hangouts, or similar apps, we did not want to confuse matters by making you switch to an IM app that piggybacks on a full-fledged social network. Simply because, what we are looking for through this exercise is a replacement for WhatsApp, which was in turn a replacement of the plain and simple SMS and similarly relies on phone numbers instead of online identities.

**BlackBerry Messenger**

Price: Free

Available for: BlackBerry, iOS and Android

Download: <http://dgit.in/bbmdl1>

It wasn't a long time ago that BlackBerry smartphones boasted of BlackBerry Messenger (BBM) as an exclusive feature. However, that has changed, and you don't need to be on the BlackBerry platform anymore to use BBM or connect to your friends who use the client. The app is now also available for Android and iOS platforms, and BlackBerry has often mentioned that it will also be available for Windows Phone soon. The Android and iOS versions are fairly stripped down at the moment, with just basic chatting available, but it is expected that these two versions will also get voice and video chat features in the near future, bringing them at par with the version that currently runs on BlackBerry 10 devices. And BlackBerry, FYI, we would love the screen share feature as well.

What we really like is the fact that not anyone and everyone can contact you

through BBM. The PIN based friend list population means you have better control over who ends up there and who doesn't.

Hike

Price: Free

Available for: BlackBerry, iOS, Android, S40 & S60 and Windows Phone

Download: <http://get.hike.in/>

This is one app which took on the challenge of dealing with a crowd of very similar apps, and has emerged from the slugfest stronger and much more polished. For starters, the interface has been tweaked for the better, and retains its visual appeal while remaining very functional. Not to be left behind, stickers are also available for you to use, if words don't offer the same mileage. Hike has a rather unique feature, it sends your message as an SMS in case the other participant goes offline for some reason, and the reply to that SMS will arrive in the same chat window within Hike. Do note, this is limited to contacts based out of India only. The "last seen" feature may be

